

either monochrome or color, and have a digital watch face that is either always on or can be woken up from sleep much like a smartphone display. To qualify as a smartwatch, however, they should ideally possess secondary functions such as a calculator, organizer and more complex ones such as a note keeping app and fitness tracking capabilities. For this, most high-end smartwatches include electronic sensors such as a heart rate sensor, accelerometer, thermometer, altimeter, barometer, compass, and chronograph. More expensive models are fitted with GPS chips making them great devices for navigation.

Smartwatches fall into two categories: The first type referred to as standalone smartwatches, do not require pairing with another device. These smartwatches generally have a SIM card slot for Internet connectivity and are powered by faster processors. This means they are generally more expensive and relatively heavier than the other the other type, aka the pairable type. These smartwatches requires a connection to a primary device, generally via Bluetooth. If used without another device, they have limited functionality. On the plus side these watches, once synced with your phone, can deliver notifications for quick viewing , allow you to answer or reject call, reply to texts, and create calendar events, notes and reminders, to name just a few features.

For a more detailed list of features, let's take a quick look at some of the most popular smartwatches available in the market right now.

Pebble Watches

The device that started it all, the Pebble Watch is the currently the highest selling smartwatch around the world. Compatible with iOS and Android via their official apps, the watch is paired via Bluetooth and comes with its own set of downloadable apps and customizable watchfaces. It is available in three different variants: the Pebble Classic, Pebble Time, and Pebble Time Steel. The Classic has an e-paper display, similar to that found in the Kindle e-reader. This scratch-resistant display is easy to read even in direct sunlight.

The successor to the Pebble Classic, the Pebble Time, features an updated color e-paper display, as compared with the monochrome one of the Pebble Classic. The Time boasts a couple of significant improvements, most notably an integrated microphone for replying to incoming notifications or recording short voice notes. Pebble have added a 'smart accessory port', to the Time, which they believe will allow developers to